

Trading, in Pub English

Every term you'll meet in the analysis, the school and the journal — explained the way a mate would across a table, not the way a textbook would. 40 terms, no jargon left standing.

Ask The price you buy at. Always a touch higher than the bid — the gap is the spread.	Liquidity How easily you can trade without moving the price. Majors have oceans of it; exotics have puddles.
Base currency The first currency in a pair. The price says how much of the second one unit of this buys.	Lot A standard position size: 100,000 units of the base currency. Minis (10k) and micros (1k) exist for sane humans.
Bearish Expecting a price to fall. The bear swipes down.	Major A heavyweight dollar pair: EUR/USD, GBP/USD, USD/JPY and friends. Tightest costs, deepest markets.
Bid The price you sell at.	Margin The deposit your broker holds while a leveraged trade is open.
Breakout Price escaping a level it's been stuck under (or over). Real ones keep going; fake ones snap back and take beginners' money with them.	Margin call The broker telling you your account can no longer support your open trades. You never want the call.
Bullish Expecting a price to rise. The bull tosses up.	Pip The market's inch — the standard unit of price movement, usually the fourth decimal place.
Candlestick One bar of price history: open, high, low, close, drawn so you can read the fight at a glance.	Pipette A tenth of a pip. Fine print.
Central bank A country's money authority (Bank of England, the Fed). The single biggest force in forex.	Position sizing Deciding how much to trade so a normal loss stays boring. The most underrated skill in the game.
Cross A pair without the US dollar in it, like EUR/GBP.	Quote currency The second currency in a pair — the one the price is counted in.
Drawdown How far your account has fallen from its peak. The number that decides whether you survive long enough to be right.	R-multiple Profit or loss measured in units of what you risked. Risked £50, made £100 — that's +2R. The only honest scoreboard.
Economic calendar The diary of scheduled news releases — rate decisions, jobs numbers, inflation prints — that move markets.	Range A market bouncing between a floor and a ceiling, going nowhere with enthusiasm.
Entry The price where your trade opens.	Resistance A ceiling where selling has repeatedly shown up.
Exotic A major currency paired with a smaller economy's. Wide spreads, sudden moves — not a beginner's playground.	Retest Price returning to a broken level to check it holds from the other side. The polite entry.
Fill The actual price your order executed at, which is not always the price you asked for.	Risk-reward What you stand to make versus what you're risking. 2:1 means the win pays double the loss.
Fundamentals The economic story behind a currency: growth, inflation, interest rates, politics.	Slippage The difference between the price you wanted and the price you got, usually in fast markets.
Going long Buying — profiting if the price rises.	Spread The gap between bid and ask — the cost of every trade, paid on the way in.
Going short Selling first — profiting if the price falls. Completely normal in forex.	Stop loss The pre-set exit that caps a loss when the idea is proven wrong. Non-negotiable in our book.
Leverage Trading with more exposure than your deposit. Multiplies both directions — the loaded word in retail trading.	

Support

A floor where buying has repeatedly shown up. The market's memory.

Swap

The small overnight charge (or credit) for holding a position, driven by interest-rate gaps.

Take profit

The pre-set exit that banks the win at your target.

Trend

The market's prevailing direction — higher highs and higher lows up, the mirror down.

Volatility

How violently a market moves. Opportunity and danger are the same number.
